How to add your activity to the Adventure Map

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You wrote your activity in Google Docs (or similar). Here's how to get it into the TADA repo!

Summary

1. Export your doc as Markdown.
2. Save it in the right folder, correctly numbered.
3. Add a frontmatter block at the top (see below) — **this is the important part.**
4. Push, or open a Pull Request.

That's it for beginner and intermediate activities. Advanced has one extra manual step (see the note at the bottom).

1. Export your activity as Markdown

In Google Docs: **File → Download → Markdown (.md) Microsoft Word documents need to be exported to Google Docs to be formatted into a Markdown file**

Before uploading, skim the exported file for these — Google's export does this almost every time:

- Stray backslashes before punctuation, like `Choose your adventure\!` — delete them.
- Heading levels that don't match the site (`#` for the activity title, `##` for major sections, `###` for numbered steps).

2. Name the file and place it

Files are numbered per category, each restarting at 1:

```
adventure_map/adventure_map_activities/
  beginner/       →  5_beginner.md, 6_beginner.md, ...
  intermediate/   →  5_intermediate.md, ...
  advanced/        →  10_advanced.md, ...
```

Use the next open number in your category.

3. Add the frontmatter block

This is a small metadata header at the very top of the file, between two `---` lines. It's invisible on the actual page — it's what the automation reads to build your navigation links and index entry for you.

PASTE THIS AT THE START OF YOUR FILE AND FILL IN DATA

```
---
title: "Activity ?, Beginner, Intermediate, or Advanced - Your Activity Name"
description: Tactile Art & Design Adventures by the Center for Assistive Technology Training
order: ?
nav_title: "Activity ?: Your Activity Name"
index_title: "Your Activity Name"
summary: "One or two sentences describing what students do in this activity."
goals: "What students will learn or practice."
---
```

For Example:

```
---
title: "Lesson 1, Beginner - Intro to Tactile Graphics"
description: "Tactile Art & Design Adventures by the Center for Assistive Technology Traini
order: 1
nav_title: "Activity 1: Intro to Tactile Graphics"
index_title: "Introduction to Tactile Graphics"
summary: "Introduction to tactile graphics and art, with an emphasis on hands-on learning a
goals: "Develop motor skills, spatial awareness, and appreciation for accessible art."
---
```

What each field does:

Field	What it controls
`order`	Where your activity sits in the sequence
`nav_title`	Text in the Previous/Next footer link
`index_title`	Text in the Adventure Map list ("Activity 5:" prefix is added automatically)
`summary`	One-line description under your link in the Adventure Map

Field	What it controls
`goals`	The **Goals:** line under that

Everything below the frontmatter — your `#` title, Setup section, numbered steps — stays exactly like any other activity file already looks.

4. Push it

- Write access: commit and push your new file to `main`.
- No write access: open a Pull Request with it.

You do **not** need to manually edit the footer links or `04_ADVENTURE_MAP.md` yourself — an automation handles that next.

Advanced tier: one extra manual step

Advanced activities get their footer links automated the same way. But the Advanced section of `04_ADVENTURE_MAP.md` mixes real activities with hand-written section headers (like "Section A: Making 2D Shapes in OpenSCAD") that don't correspond to any file — so that index section is never auto-generated. If you're adding an advanced activity, add its line to `04_ADVENTURE_MAP.md` yourself, in the same format as the ones already there.

Before you push, check:

- ☐ File placed in the right tier folder, correctly numbered
- ☐ Frontmatter has `order`, `nav_title`, `index_title`, `summary`, and `goals` filled in
- ☐ No stray backslashes or mismatched heading levels left from the Google Docs export
- ☐ Any images have real descriptive alt text (not just a caption)
- ☐ No emojis

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